# MAT439: Commutative Algebra

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## 1 Preface

These lecture notes were taken in the course MAT439: Commutative Algebra, taught by Nian Ibne Nazrul at BRAC University, as part of the BSc in Mathematics program in Spring 2026. Each lecture corresponds to a chapter in these notes.

Nothing in these notes is original (except my mistakes); almost everything here can be found somewhere in [AM69] or [Eis95]. In particular, we adopt the notation of [AM69] for notational consistency.

If you find any mistake, please report it at mh.turjoy@yahoo.com, even if it is something very small, even if you are not sure.

## 2 Lecture 01 (02/02/26)

This lecture provides a brief review of some of the materials covered in MAT311: Abstract Algebra, with motivations and detailed explanations in definitions and proofs omitted.

### 2.1 Group Theory

**Definition 2.1** (Binary Operation)
Let $S$ be a nonempty set. A *binary operation* on $S$ is a map

$$* : S \times S \longrightarrow S.$$

We denote $*(x, y)$ by $x * y$.

**Definition 2.2**
Let $f : A \longrightarrow B$ be a map and let $C \subseteq A$. The *restriction of $f$ to $C$* is the map

$$f|_C : C \to B$$

defined by

$$f|_C(x) = f(x) \quad \text{for all } x \in C.$$

**Definition 2.3** (Group)
A *group* is an ordered pair $(G, *)$, where $G$ is a set and $*$ is a binary operation such that:

- **Associativity:** For all $g, h, k \in G$, $(g * h) * k = g * (h * k)$.
- **Identity element:** There exists an element $e \in G$ such that for all $g \in G$, $e * g = g = g * e$.
- **Inverse element:** For each $g \in G$, there exists an element $h \in G$ such that $g * h = e = h * g$.

If $(G, *)$ is a group, then we simply say $G$ is a group, when what $*$ is, is clear from the context. $G$ is called *abelian*[1] if $g * h = h * g$, for all $g, h \in G$.

**Proposition 2.4**
Let $(G, *)$ be a group. Then

- Identity element $e$ is unique.
- Inverse $h$ of an element $g \in G$ is unique. So we denote $h =: g^{-1}$.

After proving these results, we can use definite article "the" before identity element and inverse of a group element.

*Proof.*

- Suppose there are two identity elements $e_1, e_2$. Then

$$e_1 = e_1 * e_2 = e_2.$$

- Let $g \in G$ and suppose $h, k$ are two inverses of $g$. Then

$$h = h * e = h * (g * k) = (h * g) * k = e * k = k.$$

□

**Definition 2.5** (Subgroup)
Let $S$ be a subset of a group $(G, *)$, and $*|_{S \times S} : S \times S \longrightarrow G$ be the restriction of the map $*$. $S$ is called a *subgroup* of $G$ and denoted by $S \leq G$ if

- $e \in S$,
- For all $s \in S, s^{-1} \in S$,
- $\mathrm{Im}(*|_{S \times S}) \subseteq S$.

In other words, if $(S, *|_{S \times S})$ is a group by itself.

One of the philosophies in mathematics in general is: to understand an object, you should study functions from that object. Following definition is important in that sense.

[1] Some people capitalize the letter "A" in honor of mathematician Niels Henrik Abel, who contributed enormously in the subject.

**Definition 2.6** (Group Homomorphism)
A map between groups $f : (G, *) \longrightarrow (H, \#)$ is called a *group homomorphism* if

$$f(g * h) = f(g)\#f(h) \quad \forall g, h \in G.$$

The set

$$\ker f := f^{-1}(\{e\}),$$

is called the *kernel* of $f$.

**Proposition 2.7**
$\ker f \leq G$.

*Proof.* We verify three conditions of a subring:

1.

$$\begin{aligned} & f(e_G) = f(e_G * e_G) = f(e_G)\#f(e_G) \\ \implies & f(e_G)\#(f(e_G))^{-1} = (f(e_G)\#f(e_G))\#(f(e_G))^{-1} \\ \implies & f(e_G)\#(f(e_G))^{-1} = f(e_G)\#(f(e_G)\#(f(e_G))^{-1}) \\ \implies & e_G = f(e_G) \\ \therefore & e_G \in \ker f. \end{aligned}$$

2. Let $s \in \ker f$, then $f(s) = e_H$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} & f(s * s^{-1}) = f(e_G) = e_H \\ \implies & f(s)\#f(s^{-1}) = e_H \\ \implies & e_H\#f(s^{-1}) = e_H \\ \implies & f(s^{-1}) = e_H \\ \therefore & s^{-1} \in \ker f. \end{aligned}$$

3. Let $K = \ker f$ and $s \in \mathrm{Im}(*|_{K\times K})$. Then there exists $(r, t) \in K \times K$ such that $r * t = s$. We have to prove $s \in K$.

$$f(s) = f(r * t) = f(r)\#f(t) = e_H\#e_H = e_H.$$

Therefore, $\mathrm{Im}(*|_{K\times K}) \subseteq K$.

□

**Proposition 2.8**
For all $g \in G$, $g\ker f = \mathrm{kef} fg$.

Generalising kernel using this key property, we define the following:

**Definition 2.9** (Normal Subgroup)
A subgroup $N$ of a group $G$ is called *normal* if $gN = Ng$ for all $g \in G$. We denote it by $N \trianglelefteq G$.

**Definition 2.10** (Coset)
Let $H \leq (G, *)$. Then for an element $g \in G$, the set

$$gH := \{g * h : h \in H\},$$

is called a *left coset* of $G$. Similarly,

$$Hg := \{h * g : h \in H\},$$

is called a *right coset*.

**Definition 2.11** (Quotient Group)
Let $N \trianglelefteq G$. Then

$$G/N := \{gN : g \in G\},$$

is a group with group operation $\cdot$ given by

$$(gN) \cdot (hN) = (gh)N.$$

We call it a *quotient group*.

The map $\pi : G \longrightarrow G/N$ given via $g \mapsto gN$ is a group homomorphism. It is called *quotient map*. Kernel of this map is $N$. Hence,

**Theorem 2.12**
Any normal subgroup $N$ of a group $G$ can be written as the kernel of some group homomorphism.

**Theorem 2.13** (1st Isomorphism Theorem)
Let $f : G \longrightarrow H$ be a group homomorphism. Then $G/\ker f$ is isomorphic to $\mathrm{Im} f$ by the isomorphism given via $g\ker f \mapsto f(g)$.

## 2.2 Ring Theory

**Definition 2.14** (Ring)
A *ring* is a datum $(R, +, \cdot)$, where $R$ is a set and $+, \cdot$ are binary operations such that:

- $(R, +)$ is an abelian group (so $R$ has an identity element[a] denoted by 0.
- $(g \cdot h) \cdot j = g \cdot (h \cdot j), \forall g, h, j \in R$.
- $g \cdot (h + j) = g \cdot h + g \cdot j$ and $(h + j) \cdot g = h \cdot g + j \cdot g, \forall g, h, j \in R$.

[a] We call it additive identity in the context of rings.

If there exists an element $1 \in R$ such that for all $x \in R, x \cdot 1 = x = 1 \cdot x$, then 1 is called *multiplicative identity* and $R$ is called a *ring with identity*. In this course, we are primarily interested in commutative[2] rings with identity. So, from now on, every ring in these notes is a commutative ring with identity unless stated otherwise.

**Proposition 2.15**
If additive and multiplicative identities of a ring $R$ are equal, then $R$ is the trivial ring, i.e., $R = \{0\}$.

*Proof.* Let $x \in R$, then

$$x = x \cdot 1 = x \cdot 0 = 0 \implies R = \{0\}.$$

□

[2] As the name of the course suggests XD

**Definition 2.16** (Ring Homomorphism)
Suppose $(R_1, +_1, *_1)$ and $(R_2, +_2, *_2)$ are two rings. Then a map $f : (R_1, +_1, *_1) \longrightarrow (R_2, +_2, *_2)$ is called a *ring homomorphism* if

- $f(a +_1 b) = f(a) +_2 f(b)$,
- $f(a *_1 b) = f(a) *_2 f(b)$,
- $f(1_{R_1}) = 1_{R_2}$.

**Exercise 2.17**
To show that the third condition of the ring homomorphism is independent of the other twos, find an example of a map between two rings that satisfies first two conditions, but not the third one.

**Answer** (Instructor)**.** *An example that satisfies the conditions $f(a+b) = f(a) + f(b)$ and $f(ab) = f(a)f(b)$ but not $f(1) = 1$ is the map $f : (\mathbb{Z}, +, *) \to (\mathbb{Z}, +, *)$, $f(n) = 0$ for all $n$, i.e. the zero map. $f(a+b) = 0 = 0 + 0 = f(a) + f(b)$, $f(ab) = 0 = 0 \times 0 = f(a)f(b)$, but $f(1) = 0 \neq 1$.*

**Definition 2.18** (Subring)
Suppose $S \subseteq R$ where $(R, +, \cdot)$ is a ring. If $(S, +|_{S\times S}, *|_{S\times S})$ is a ring by itself, then $S$ is called a subring of $R$.

**Definition 2.19** (Ideal)
An *ideal* $I$ of a ring $R$ is a subset of $R$ and satisfies:

- $I$ is a subgroup of $(R, +)$,
- Let $IR := \{i \cdot r : i \in I \text{ and } r \in R\}$. Then $IR \subset I$.

**Example 2.20** (Principle Ideal)
Suppose $a \in R$. Then $(a) := \{a \cdot r : r \in R\}$ is an ideal, also called as *principle ideal* or ideal generated by $a$.[a]

[a] It seemed like every non-trivial ideal should be of this form. But Ernest Kummer first discovered ideals that were not generated by a single element, which exploded the subject.

**Example 2.21**
$R = \mathbb{Z}$ has an infinite number of ideals, explicitly

$$I = (n) = n\mathbb{Z}, \quad \forall\, n \geq 0.$$

In fact, every ideal of $\mathbb{Z}$ is of this form[a]. For all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, $(n)$ is an ideal of $\mathbb{Z}$. We now prove the converse.

Let $P$ be an ideal of $\mathbb{Z}$. If $P = \{0\}$, then $P = (0)$.

Assume $P \neq \{0\}$. Since $P \leq \mathbb{Z}$, there exists a positive integer in $P$. Let

$$n = \min\{\, k \in P \mid k > 0 \,\}.$$

We claim that $P = (n)$. Since $n \in P$ and $P$ is an ideal, for any $z \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$zn \in P,$$

hence $(n) \subseteq P$.

Conversely, let $p \in P$. By the Euclid's Division lemma, there exist $q, r \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$p = qn + r, \quad 0 \leq r < n.$$

Since $p \in P$ and $qn \in P$, and $P$ is an ideal, we have

$$r = p - qn \in P.$$

By the minimality of $n$, it follows that $r = 0$. Hence

$$p = qn \in (n),$$

and therefore $P \subseteq (n)$.

Thus,

$$P = (n).$$

[a] It is very rare that when you have a ring, you can list all of its ideals.

**Example 2.22** (Polynomial Ring)
Let $R$ be a ring, $x$ be an indeterminate and define $R[x]$ be the set of all formal sums of the form

$$\sum a_i x^i = a_n x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0, \quad \text{where } \{i : a_i \neq 0\} \text{ is finite.}$$

Given two polynomials $f = \sum a_i x^i$ and $g = \sum b_i x^i$ in $R[x]$, the sum of $f$ and $g$ is defined as

$$f + g = \sum (a_i + b_i) x^i,$$

and the product of $f$ and $g$ as

$$f \cdot g = \sum c_i x^i, \quad \text{where } c_i = \sum_{j,k:j+k=i} a_j b_k.$$

With this rule of addition and multiplication, $(R[x], +, \cdot)$ becomes a ring, called *polynomial ring.*[a] We can further define polynomial ring $R[x][y]$ over $R[x]$ and it turns out that $R[x][y] \cong R[x,y]$[b]. Some of the ideals of the ring $R[x,y]$ are:

- $\langle x \rangle = \{xf(x,y) : f(x,y) \in R[x,y]\} = \{$All the polynomials with degree of $x$ *at least* $1\}$.
- $\langle x, y \rangle = \{xf(x,y) + yg(x,y) : f, g \in R[x,y]\} = \{$All the polynomials with degree of no constant term$\}$.

[a] In the definition above, each $a_i \in R$ is called the coefficients of the polynomial; $a_i$ is the coefficient of $x^i$ and the zero element given as the polynomial with zero coefficients.
[b] Polynomial ring of several indeterminates is not defined here though.

# 3 Lecture 02 (09/02/26)

**Proposition 3.1**
Let $\mathbb{K}$ be a field. Then every ideal of $\mathbb{K}[x]$ is principle, but it is not true in general in $\mathbb{K}[x_1, \cdots, x_n]$ for $n > 1$.

*Proof.* We proceed similarly as in we did in the case of $\mathbb{Z}$. But before that, we have to prove analogous Euclid's Division lemma for $\mathbb{K}[x]$.

**Claim 3.2.** *Let $f, g \in \mathbb{K}[x]$. If $g \neq 0$, then there exists polynomials $q, r \in \mathbb{K}[x]$ such $f = gq + r$, where* $\deg r < \deg g$.

*Proof of claim.* If $g$ divides $f$, then $r = 0$ and we are done. If not, let $r = f - gq$ be the polynomial of least degree among all polynomials of the form $f - lg$ with $l \in \mathbb{K}[x]$. Then we must have $\deg g > \deg r$. Otherwise, let the leading term of $r$ and $g$ be $ax^m$ and $bx^n$ respectively. Then

$$r - g \cdot ab^{-1}x^{m-n} = f - gq - g \cdot ab^{-1}x^{m-n} = f - g(q + ab^{-1}x^{m-n}),$$

has smaller degree than $r$ and is of the given form, which contradicts minimality of the degree of $r$. □

If $f \in \mathbb{K}[x]$, then $(f)$ is an ideal. Conversely, if $I$ is an ideal of $\mathbb{K}[x]$, we claim that $(g) = I$, where $g$ is a polynomial of least positive degree in $I$. Clearly, $(g) \subseteq I$. Let $f \in I$, then by the Claim 3.2, there exists $q, r \in \mathbb{K}[x]$ such that

$$f = gq + r, \quad \text{where } \deg r < \deg g.$$

Here $r = 0$, otherwise, $r = f - gq \in I$, which contradicts the minimality of the degree of $g$. Hence, $f = gq \in (g)$, which implies $I \subseteq (g)$. Therefore, $I = (g)$.

However, in general, in $\mathbb{K}[x_1, \cdots, x_n]$ for $n > 1$, every ideal is not principle. As counter-example, we can consider the finitely generated ideal $(x_1, x_2)$. □

## 3.1 Quotient Ring

**Definition 3.3** (Quotient Ring)
Suppose $R$ is a (commutative) ring (with identity), and suppose $I$ is an ideal of $R$. So, $I$ is an additive subgroup of the abelian group $(R,+)$[a]. $R/I$ is a quotient group where elements look like $r+I$. Define multiplication on $R/I$:

$$(r+I)\cdot(r'+I) = rr'+I.$$

Then $(R/I,+,\cdot)$ becomes a ring called *quotient ring* of $R$ modulo $I$.

[a]For an abelian group, every subgroup is normal, $r+H = H+r$.

Since cosets of an additive group $(R,+)$ can have multiple representatives, we have to check well-definedness of the multiplication defined above, i.e., if $r+I = h+I$ and $r'+I = h'+I$, then $(r+I)\cdot(r'+I) = (h+I)\cdot(h'+I)$. Notice, $r+I = h+I$ and $r'+I = h'+I \Leftrightarrow r-h \in I$ and $r'-h' \in I$. Since $I$ is an ideal,

$$(r-h)r' \in I \implies rr'-hr' \in I \text{ and}$$

$$h(r'-h') \in I \implies hr'-hh' \in I.$$

Since $I$ is an additive subgroup,

$$\begin{aligned}
&(rr'-hr')+(hr'-hh') \in I\\
\implies &rr'+(-hr'+hr')-hh' \in I\\
\implies &rr'-hh' \in I\\
\implies &rr'+I = hh'+I\\
&\therefore (r+I)\cdot(r'+I) = (h+I)\cdot(h'+I).
\end{aligned}$$

Associativity, distributive property, existence of identity (which is $0+I = I$) and commutativity of $(R/I,+,\cdot)$ are routine checks.

**Student Question**
Can we take quotient modulo an ideal of a non-commutative ring?

**Answer** (Instructor)**.** *Yes, we can! In that case, the ideal should be two-sided ideal. Recall, in a non-commutative ring $R$, an additive subgroup $I$ of $R$ is called a* left ideal *if $RI \subseteq I$ and* right ideal *if $IR \subseteq I$. If $I$ is both left and right ideal, then we call it a* two-sided ideal. *See Example 3.4.*

**Example 3.4** (Clifford Algebra)
Suppose $\mathcal{V}$ is a vector space over $\mathbb{K}$. Then its tensor algebra over $\mathbb{K}$ is

$$T(\mathcal{V}) = \bigoplus_{n\geq 0} \mathcal{V}^{\oplus n},$$

where $\mathcal{V}^{\oplus 0} := \mathbb{K}, \mathcal{V}^{\oplus 1} := \mathcal{V}, \cdots, \mathcal{V}^{\oplus n} := \mathcal{V}\otimes\cdots\otimes\mathcal{V}(n \text{ times})$.

$T(\mathcal{V})$ is a ring with multiplicative identity given by $1 \in \mathbb{K}$, which is non-commutative as $x\otimes y \neq y\otimes x$.

Now, suppose $Q$ is a non-degenerate bilinear form on $\mathcal{V}$. Consider the ideal

$$\mathfrak{a} = \langle v\otimes v - Q(v,v)\cdot 1\rangle_{v\in\mathcal{V}}.$$

Here $\mathfrak{a}$ is a two-sided ideal and $T(\mathcal{V})/\mathfrak{a} =: \text{Clifford}(\mathcal{V},Q)$ is called *Clifford Algebra*, which is an example of a quotient ring of a non-commutative ring.

**Proposition 3.5** (Correspondence Theorem)
Suppose $R$ is a ring and $I$ is is an ideal. Then there is an $1-1$ order-preserving correspondence between the ideals of $R$ containing $I$ and the ideals of the quotient ring $R/I$. The order-preserving $1-1$ correspondence is given by: if $J'$ is an ideal of $R/I$, then the corresponding ideal in $R$ is given by $\pi^{-1}(J')$.[a]

[a] $\pi$ is the canonical projection map that maps each element $r$ of $R$ to $r+I$ in $R/I$.

*Proof.* Step (1). First we show that if $J'$ is an ideal of the quotient $R/I$, then $\pi^{-1}(J')$ is an ideal in $R$.

Firstly, $0 \in \pi^{-1}(J')$, because $\pi(0) = I \in J'$ as $J'$ is an ideal of $R/I$, so it must contain the additive identity $I$ of $R/I$.

Suppose $x, y \in \pi^{-1}(J')$. So $\pi(x) = x + I, \pi(y) = y + I \in J'$. Since $J'$ is an ideal, we have

$$\begin{aligned} &(x+I) - (y+I) \in J' \\ \implies &(x-y) + I \in J' \\ \implies &\pi(x-y) \in J' \\ \implies &(x-y) \in \pi^{-1}(J'). \end{aligned}$$

Hence, using subgroup criterion, $pi^{-1}(J')$ is an additive subgroup of $R$.

Also, if $r \in R$, then $r \cdot \pi^{-1}(J') \subseteq \pi^{-1}(J')$. To see that, suppose $x \in \pi^{-1}(J')$, which implies $x + I \in J'$, which implies $(r+I)(x_I) \in J'$ as $(r+I) \in R/I$, and that implies

$$rx + I \in J' \implies \pi(rx) \in J' \implies rx \in \pi^{-1}(J').$$

$\therefore \pi^{-1}(J')$ is indeed an ideal of $R$.

Step (2). We want to show that if $J'$ is an ideal of $R/I$, then the ideal $J = \pi^{-1}(J')$ of $R$ contains $I$.

Let $x \in I$, then $\pi(x) = I \in J'$, which implies $x \in \pi^{-1}(J')$. Therefore, $\ker \pi = I \subseteq \pi^{-1}(J')$.

Step (3). Lastly, we wish to prove the correspondence is an order-preserving bijection. Define two maps $\phi$ and $\tilde{\phi}$ as follows:

$$\begin{tikzcd} \{J \ : \ J \text{ is an ideal of } R \text{ containing } I\} \arrow[r, bend right, "\tilde{\phi}"'] & \{J' \ : \ J' \text{ is an ideal of } R/I\} \arrow[l, bend right, "\phi"'] \end{tikzcd}$$

$\phi(J') = \pi^{-1}(J')$ and $\tilde{\phi}(J) = \pi(J)$. We will prove $\phi$ and $\tilde{\phi}$ are inverses of each other and if $J_1' \subseteq J_2'$, then $\phi(J_1') \subseteq \phi(J_2')$.

Firstly, since $\pi$ is surjective, $\pi(\pi^{-1}(J')) = J'$, equivalently, $(\tilde{\phi} \circ \phi)(J') = J'$. And for $I \subseteq J, J + I = J$, and so $\pi^{-1}(\pi(J)) = J$, equivalently, $(\phi \circ \tilde{\phi})(J) = J$. So $\phi$ and $\tilde{\phi}$ are inverses of each other.

Furthermore, let $x \in \phi(J_1') = \pi^{-1}(J_1')$. Then $\pi(x) \in J_1' \subseteq J_2'$. So, $x \in \pi^{-1}(J_2') = \phi(J_2')$. Hence, we have $\phi(J_1') \subseteq \phi(J_2')$, completing the proof.

□

**Definition 3.6**
Let $R$ be a ring.

An element $r \in R$ is called a *zero-divisor* if there is a non-zero $y \in R$ such that $r \cdot y = 0$.

$R$ is called an *integral domain* if it does not have any non-zero zero-divisors.

An element $r \in R$ is called *nilpotent* if $r^n = 0$ for some $n > 0$.

A *unit* $r \in R$ is an element that "divides 1" – i.e., for which there exists $y \in R, y \neq 0$ such that $xy = 1$.

$R$ is a *field* if $1 \neq 0$ and every non-zero element is a unit.

**Note 3.7**

- 0 is also a zero-divisor.
- Nilpotent elements are all zero-divisors. To see that, suppose $r$ is a nilpotent element and $r^n = 0$. If $n = 1$, then $r$ is trivially zero-divisor. Otherwise, we have $r^{n-1} \in R$ such that $r \cdot r^{n-1} = 0$.
- The set of all units of a ring $R$ forms an abelian group under multiplication and it is denoted by $R^\times$.
- A unit cannot be a zero-divisor in $R \neq (0)$. Suppose $x$ is a unit with $xy = 1$. If $x$ is also a zero-divisor, $sx = 0$ for some $s \neq 0$.

$$sx = 0 \implies (sx)y = 0y \implies s(xy) = 0 \implies s \cdot 1 = 0 \implies s = 0 \text{ (contradiction!)}.$$

  So,
- A field is an integral domain.

**Proposition 3.8**
Suppose $R$ is a ring and $R \neq (0)$. Then the following are equivalent:

1. $R$ is a field.
2. $R$ only has two ideals: $(0)$ and $(1)$.
3. Every homomorphism[a] of $R$ to a non-zero ring is injective.

[a] Remember we require $f(1) = 1$ for a ring homomorphism $f$.

*Proof.*

- $(1) \implies (2)$. Suppose $R$ is a field. That means, every non-zero element is a unit. Let $I$ be an ideal of $R$. If $I = (0)$, we are done. Otherwise, there exists non-zero $x \in I \subseteq R$. Hence, $x$ is a unit, i.e., there exits $y \in R$ such that $xy = yx = 1$. Since $I$ is an ideal, $y \cdot x \in I \implies 1 \in I \implies I = (1) = R$.
- $(2) \implies (3)$. Suppose $R$ has only two ideals: $(0)$ and $(1)$. And let $f : R \longrightarrow S \neq (0)$ be a ring homomorphism. $\ker f$ is an ideal of $R$, and it can be either $(0)$ or $(1)$ as per hypothesis. But $\ker f \neq R$ since we at least have $1_R \neq \ker f$ by definition. Hence, $\ker f = (0)$, which implies $f$ is injective[3].
- $(3) \implies (1)$. Suppose every homomorphism of $R$ to a non-zero ring is injective. We want to show that $R$ is a field, i.e., every non-zero element is a unit. Suppose there is an element $x \in R$ which is not a unit. Then $(x) \neq (1)$ (because if it was $(1)$, then that would mean $y \cdot x = 1 \implies x$ is a unit).

  Consider the canonical projection map $\pi : R \to R/(x)$ for which $\ker \pi = (x)$. Since $(x) \neq (1)$, i.e., since $(x) \neq R, R/(x) \neq (0)$. So, $\ker \pi = (0)$ by hypothesis, which implies $(x) = (0) \implies x = 0$. Hence, the only non-unit in $R$ is 0, and so every non-zero element should be a unit.

□

# 4 Lecture 03 (15/02/26)

## 4.1 Prime & Maximal Ideals

**Definition 4.1** (Prime Ideal)
An ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ in $R$ is called *prime* if $\mathfrak{p} \neq (1)$ and if $xy \in \mathfrak{p}$ implies $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ or $y \in \mathfrak{p}$.

[3] Recall from the first course in algebra: A ring homomorphism is injective iff its kernel is $(0)$.

**Example 4.2**
Take the ring $R := (\mathbb{Z}, +, \times)$. Then prime ideals of $R$ are precisely the ideals $(p)$, where $p$ is prime.

Because, first of all, every ideal of $R$ is of the form $(n)$.

And we claim that "$(n)$ is prime ideal iff $n$ is a prime number;" equivalently, "$ab \in (n) \implies a \in (n)$ or $b \in (n)$ iff $n$ is a prime number;" equivalently, "$n|ab \implies n|a$ or $n|b$ iff $n$ is a prime number." We prove that the last statement is indeed true.

**Claim 4.3.** *For all $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, n|ab \implies n|a$ or $n|b$ iff $n$ is a prime number.*

*Proof of claim.* Let for all $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, n|ab \implies n|a$ or $n|b$. And suppose $n$ is composite. Then there exists integers $a' \neq 1, b' \neq 1$ such that $n = a'b'$. Then $n = a'b' \Big| a' \frac{\text{lcm}(a',b')}{a'}$ but $a'b' \not| a'$ and $a'b' \not| \frac{\text{lcm}(a',b')}{a'}$, contradicting the hypothesis. Hence, $n$ must be prime.

Conversely, let $n$ be prime. If $n|a$, we are done. If $n \not| a$, then $px + ay = 1 \implies pbx + aby = b$ for some $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$[a]. Since $p|pbx$ and $p|(ab)y$[b], therefore $p|b$. □

Therefore, only prime ideals in $\mathbb{Z}$ are principle ideals generated by prime numbers.

[a] Bezout's identity.
[b] since $p|ab$ by hypothesis.

**Definition 4.4** (Maximal Ideal)
An ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ in $R$ is called *maximal* if $\mathfrak{m} \neq (1)$ and if there is no ideal $\mathfrak{a}$ in $R$ such that

$$\mathfrak{m} \subset \mathfrak{a} \subset R \quad \text{(strict inclusion)}.$$

In other words, the only ideal that strictly contains $\mathfrak{m}$ is $(1)$.

**Proposition 4.5**
1. An ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime if and only if $R/\mathfrak{p}$ is an integral domain.
2. An ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ is maximal if and only if $R/\mathfrak{m}$ is a field.

*Proof.*
1. Assume $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal. Let $a + \mathfrak{p}, b + \mathfrak{p} \in R/\mathfrak{p}$ and $(a + \mathfrak{p}) \cdot (b + \mathfrak{p}) = ab + \mathfrak{p} = 0$[4], and that implies $ab \in \mathfrak{p}$. Since $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime, $a \in \mathfrak{p} \implies a + \mathfrak{p} = 0$ or $b \in \mathfrak{p} \implies b + \mathfrak{p} = 0$. So, only zero-divisor in $R/\mathfrak{p}$ is 0, i.e., $R/\mathfrak{p}$ is an integral domain.

   Conversely, assume that $R/\mathfrak{p}$ is an integral domain. Let $ab \in \mathfrak{p}$. Then $0 = ab + \mathfrak{p} = (a + \mathfrak{p})(b + \mathfrak{p})$, which implies that $a + \mathfrak{p} = 0$ or $b + \mathfrak{p} = 0$, since $R/\mathfrak{p}$ is an integral domain. Thus, $a \in \mathfrak{p}$ or $b \in \mathfrak{p}$ and so $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal.

2. Suppose $\mathfrak{m}$ is a maximal ideal of $R$. By the Correspondence Theorem, there is a bijection between the set of ideals $\mathfrak{a}$ of $R$ containing $\mathfrak{m}$ and the set of ideals of $R/\mathfrak{m}$. Since $\mathfrak{m}$ is maximal, the only ideals of $R$ containing $\mathfrak{m}$ are: $\mathfrak{m}$ and $R$. Therefore, the only ideals of $R/\mathfrak{m}$ are: $(0), (1)$. Hence, $R/\mathfrak{m}$ has no nontrivial ideals, so it is a field.

   Conversely, suppose $R/\mathfrak{m}$ is a field. Then its only ideals are $(0)$ and $R/\mathfrak{m}$. By the Correspondence Theorem, the ideals of $R/\mathfrak{m}$ correspond bijectively to the ideals of $R$ containing $\mathfrak{m}$. Therefore, the only ideals of $R$ containing $\mathfrak{m}$ are: $\mathfrak{m}$ and $R$. Hence, $\mathfrak{m}$ is a maximal ideal of $R$.

□

**Corollary 4.6**
Every maximal ideal is prime, but the converse does not hold true.

[4] It is clear from the context that $0 \in R/\mathfrak{p}$.

*Proof.* Let $\mathfrak{m}$ be a maximal ideal in $R$. Then $R/\mathfrak{m}$ is a field. Then $R/\mathfrak{m}$ is an integral domain automatically. Therefore, $\mathfrak{m}$ is a prime ideal.

But $(0)$ is a prime ideal in $\mathbb{Z}$, but not maximal ideal because $(0) \subset (p) \subset (1)$ (strict inclusion). □

**Theorem 4.7**
Suppose $f : R \longrightarrow R'$ is a ring homomorphism, and let $\mathfrak{p}'$ be a prime ideal in $R'$. Then, $f^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}')$ – the preimage of the ideal is a prime ideal in $R$.

*Proof.* Suppose $xy \in f^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}')$, which implies $f(xy) \in \mathfrak{p}'$, and that implies $f(x)f(y) \in \mathfrak{p}'$, and that implies $f(x) \in \mathfrak{p}'$ or $f(y) \in \mathfrak{p}'$, and that implies $x \in f^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}')$ or $y \in f^{-1}(y)$, which proves $f^{-1}(\mathfrak{p}')$ is a prime ideal. □

But preimage of a maximal ideal may not be maximal.

*Counter-example.* Consider the inclusion map $\iota : \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow \mathbb{Q}$. Since $\mathbb{Q}$ is a field, its only ideals are: $(0)$ and $(1)$. So $(0)$ is a maximal ideal. But $\iota^{-1}((0)) = (0) \subset (2) \subset (1)$ is not maximal in $\mathbb{Z}$. □

**Theorem 4.8** (Existence of a Maximal Ideal)
Every ring $R \neq (0)$ has at least one maximal ideal.

*Proof.* We use Zorn's lemma.

**Theorem 4.9** (Zorn's Lemma)
Let $(S, \leq)$ be a non-empty partially ordered set [a] (also known as poset). If every chain[b] in $S$ has an upper bound[c] in $S$, then $S$ has at least one maximal element.

[a] which means that $\leq$ is a relation on $S$ satisfying:
- $x \leq x$ for all $x \in S$,
- $x \leq y$ and $y \leq x$ implies $x = y$ for all $x, y \in S$,
- $x \leq y, y \leq z \implies x \leq z$ for all $x, y, z \in S$.

[b] A *chain* in $S$ is a subset $C$ of $S$ such that for any $x, y \in C$ we have either $x \leq y$ or $y \leq x$.
[c] an element $u$ such that $x \leq u$ for all $x \in C$

*Proof of Zorn's lemma.* Omitted. □

Let $\sum$ be the set of all ideals $\mathfrak{a} \neq (1)$ and define partial order $\subseteq$ using set inclusion. So $(\sum, \subseteq)$ is a poset. To apply Zorn's lemma, we need to show that every chain in $(\sum, \subseteq)$ has an upper bound in $\sum$.

Suppose $\mathcal{C} := \{\mathfrak{a}_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in J}$ is an arbitrary chain. So $\mathfrak{a}_\alpha \subseteq \mathfrak{a}_\beta$ or $\mathfrak{a}_\beta \subseteq \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$ for all $\alpha, \beta \in J$. Define

$$\mathfrak{a} := \bigcup_{\alpha \in J} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha,$$

which qualifies as an ideal because $\mathfrak{a}$ is a subgroup of $R$ and closed under multiplication by any elements of $R$:

- $0 \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$ for all $\alpha \in J$, which implies $0 \in \mathfrak{a}$.
- Suppose $x, y \in \mathfrak{a}$. So $x \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha, y \in \mathfrak{a}_\beta$ for some $\alpha, \beta \in J$. Since $\mathfrak{a}_\alpha, \mathfrak{a}_\beta \in \mathcal{C}$, without loss of generality, let $\mathfrak{a}_\alpha \subseteq \mathfrak{a}_\beta$. Then $x - y \in \mathfrak{a}_\beta$, implying $x - y \in \mathfrak{a}$.
- Suppose $r \in R$ and suppose $x \in \mathfrak{a}$. That means $x \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$ for some $\alpha \in J$. Hence, $rx \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$.

Clearly, $\mathfrak{a}_\alpha \subset \mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{a} \in \sum$, i.e., every chain in $\sum$ has an upper bound in $\sum$. Therefore, Zorn's lemma implies that $\sum$ has a maximal element. Hence, there is at least one maximal ideal of $R$. □

**Corollary 4.10**
Every ring $R \neq (0)$ has at least one prime ideal as well.

**Corollary 4.11**
If $\mathfrak{a} \neq (1)$ is an ideal of $R \neq (0)$, then there exists a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ containing $\mathfrak{a}$.

*Proof 1.* Theorem 4.8 guarantees existence of a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_q$ in $R/\mathfrak{m}$. Using Correspondence Theorem, we have a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ such that

$$\mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{m} \subset R \quad \text{(former inclusion is not necessarily strict).}$$

□

*Proof 2.* To be written... □

**Corollary 4.12**
Every non-unit of a ring $R$ is contained in a maximal ideal.

*Proof.* Suppose $x \in R$ is a non-unit. Then $(x) \neq (1)$ because if we had $(x) = (1)$, then there would exist $y \in R$ such that $xy = 1$, which contradicts the fact that $x$ is a non-unit. Using Corollary 4.11, we conclude that there exists a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ such that $x \in (x) \subset \mathfrak{m}$. □

### 4.2 Local Rings

**Definition 4.13** (Local Ring)
A ring $R$ is called *local* if it has only one maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$.

**Example 4.14**

- all fields are local rings. because a field has only two ideals: $(0)$ and $(1)$, so only maximal is $(0)$.
- $\mathbb{Z}_n$ (also denoted by $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$) is a local ring if and only if $n = p^a$ for some prime $p$ and positive integer $a$.

  *Proof.* To be written... □

**Non-example 4.15**
$\mathbb{Z}$ is not a local ring because all prime ideals are maximal in $\mathbb{Z}$.

**Definition 4.16** (Semi-local Ring)
A ring $R$ is called *semi-local* if number of maximal ideals in $R$ is finite.

**Example 4.17**
$Z_n$ is always semi-local since it has at least one maximal ideal and finite ideals.

**Exercise 4.18**
Is $\mathbb{K}[x]$ local? When is $\mathbb{K}[x]/(x^n)$ local?

## 5 Lecture 05 Pt. 1 (25/02/26)

### 5.1 Operations on Ideals

We can define various operations on ideals:

**Definition 5.1** (Sum of two ideals)
Suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are ideals in a ring $R$. Their *sum* $\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ is defined as

$$\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b} := \{a+b \mid a \in \mathfrak{a}, b \in \mathfrak{b}\}.$$

It is very easy to check that $\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ is an ideal:

Firstly, $0 \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $0 \in \mathfrak{b}$. So, $0+0=0 \in \mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$. Let $a_1+b_1, a_2+b_2 \in \mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ with $a_1, a_2 \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b_1, b_2 \in \mathfrak{b}$. Then

$$(a_1+b_1)-(a_2+b_2) = (a_1-a_2)+(b_1-b_2) \in \mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b},$$

because $(a_1-a_2) \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $(b_1-b_2) \in \mathfrak{b}$. Therefore, $\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ is a subgroup of $R$.

Furthermore, if $a+b \in \mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ with $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{b}$, then for any $r \in R$, we have $ra \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $rb \in \mathfrak{b}$, which implies $rx+ry = r(x+y) \in \mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$. So, $\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ is closed under multiplication by ring elements.

**Example 5.2**
Consider the ring $(\mathbb{Z}, +, \times)$. Then $(m)+(n) = \gcd(\mathrm{m}, \mathrm{n})$.

To prove that, let $d = \gcd(\mathrm{m,n})$. Since $d|m, n$, therefore, $d|mx+ny$ for all $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$. So

$$(m)+(n) = \{mx+ny \mid x, y \in \mathbb{Z}\} \subseteq (d).$$

Conversely, take $x \in (d)$. Then $x = dk$ for some $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. By Bezout's identity, there exists $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$d = mx+ny \implies dk = m(xk)+n(yk) \in (m)+(n).$$

**Proposition 5.3**
$\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ is the smallest ideal that contains both $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$.

*Proof.* We want to show that if $\mathfrak{c}$ is an ideal containing both $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$, then $\mathfrak{c}$ contains $\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$.

Take $a+b \in \mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$ with $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{b}$. Then $a \in \mathfrak{a} \subset \mathfrak{c}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{b} \subset \mathfrak{c}$. Since $\mathfrak{c}$ is an ideal, we have $a+b \in \mathfrak{c}$, implying, $\mathfrak{c}$ contains $\mathfrak{a}+\mathfrak{b}$. $\square$

More generally, we can define the following:

**Definition 5.4** (Sum of a collection of ideals)
Let $\{\mathfrak{a}_\alpha\}_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}}$ be an arbitrary collection of ideals in $R$. We can define the *sum*

$$\sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha := \left\{ \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} a_\alpha \mid a_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha \text{ and } a_\alpha = 0 \text{ for all but finitely many } \alpha \in \mathcal{A} \right\}.$$

It is straightforward to check that this is indeed an ideal, and that it is the smallest ideal of $R$ that contains $\mathfrak{a}_\alpha$ for all $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}$.

**Note 5.5**
In this definition, we allow only finitely many terms to be nonzero because no topology has been defined on the set of ideals. Therefore, we cannot discuss the convergence of an infinite sum.

**Definition 5.6** (Interseciton)
Let $\{\mathfrak{a}_\alpha\}_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}}$ be an arbitrary collection of ideals in $R$. Then *intersection*

$$\bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$$

is also an ideal.

The proof that $\bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$ is an ideal is very straightforward:

Firstly, for all $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}$, $0 \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$, so $0 \in \bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$. Moreover, take $x, y \in \bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$. Then for all for all $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}$, $x, y \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$, implying $x - y \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$. Hence, $x - y \in \bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$.

Furthermore, suppose $r \in R$, and $x \in \bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$. Then for all $\alpha \in \mathcal{A}, x \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$, implying $rx \in \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$. Thus $rx \in \bigcap_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} \mathfrak{a}_\alpha$.

**Example 5.7**
Again, consider the ring $(\mathbb{Z}, +, \times)$. $(m) \cap (n) = (\mathrm{lcm}(m, n))$.

To show that, let $l = \mathrm{lcm}(m, n)$. Since $l$ is multiple of both $m, n$, we have $(l) \subset (m)$ and $(l) \subseteq (n)$. Hence, $l \subseteq (m) \cap (n)$.

Conversely, let $k \in (m) \cap (n)$. Then $m$ and $n$ both divides $k$.

**Claim 5.8.** *If $m|k$ and $n|k$, then $l = lcm(m, n)|k$.*

*Proof.* To be written... □

So $\mathrm{lcm}(m, n)|k$, which implies $k \in (\mathrm{lcm}(m, n))$. So $(m) \cap (n) \subseteq (l)$.

So $(m) \cap (n) = (l) = (\mathrm{lcm}(m, n))$.

**Definition 5.9** (Product of Two Ideals)
Suppose $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$ are two ideals in $R$. Then their *product* $\mathfrak{ab}$ is defined as

$$\mathfrak{ab} := \left\{ \sum_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} a_\alpha b_\alpha \mid a_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}, b_\alpha \in \mathfrak{b} \text{ and } a_\alpha b_\alpha = 0 \text{ for all but finitely many } \alpha \in \mathcal{A} \right\}.$$

We now check that $\mathfrak{ab}$ is indeed an ideal:

Firstly, $0 \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $0 \in \mathfrak{b}$. So $0 \cdot 0 = 0 \in \mathfrak{ab}$. Moreover, suppose $\sum_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} a_\alpha b_\alpha, \sum_{\beta\in\mathcal{B}} a'_\beta b'_\beta \in \mathfrak{ab}$ where $a_\alpha, a'_\beta \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b_\alpha, b'_\beta \in \mathfrak{b}$, and let $\mathcal{C} = \mathcal{A} \sqcup \mathcal{B}$ be the disjoint union of $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B}$.

Then

$$\sum_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} a_\alpha b_\alpha - \sum_{\beta\in\mathcal{B}} a'_\beta b'_\beta = \sum_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} a_\alpha b_\alpha + \sum_{\beta\in\mathcal{B}} (-a'_\beta) b'_\beta = \sum_{\gamma\in\mathcal{C}} a''_\gamma b''_\gamma,$$

where $a''_\gamma = \begin{cases} a_\alpha & \text{if } \gamma \in \mathcal{A} \\ -a'_\beta & \text{if } \gamma \in \mathcal{B} \end{cases}$ and $b''_\gamma = \begin{cases} b_\alpha & \text{if } \gamma \in \mathcal{A} \\ b'_\beta & \text{if } \gamma \in \mathcal{B} \end{cases}$. And clearly, $a''_\gamma \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b''_\gamma \in \mathfrak{b}$.

Furthermore, suppose $x \in R$, and $\sum_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} a_\alpha b_\alpha \in \mathfrak{ab}$. Since the sum is finite, we can use repeated distributive law of ring $R$ to write

$$r\left(\sum_{\alpha\in\mathcal{A}} a_\alpha b_\alpha\right) = \sum_{\alpha\in\dashv} r(a_\alpha b_\alpha) = \sum_{\alpha\in\dashv} (ra_\alpha) b_\alpha, \text{ where } ra_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}, b_\alpha \in \mathfrak{b}.$$

This definition can be generalised to finitely many ideals:

**Definition 5.10** (Product of Finitely Many Ideals)
Suppose $\{\mathfrak{a}_1, \cdots, \mathfrak{a}_n\}$ is a finite collection of ideals in a ring $R$. Then

$$\mathfrak{a}_1 \cdots \mathfrak{a}_n := \left\{ \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} a_{1_\alpha} \cdots a_{n_\alpha} \mid a_{k_\alpha} \in \mathfrak{a}_k \text{ and } a_{1_\alpha} \cdots a_{n_\alpha} = 0 \text{ for all but finitely many } \alpha \in \mathcal{A} \right\}.$$

Multiplication distributes over sum.

**Lemma 5.11** (Distributivity for Product and sum)
$\mathfrak{c}(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) = \mathfrak{c}\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c}\mathfrak{b}$ for ideals $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}, \mathfrak{c}$ in ring $R$.

*Proof.* Suppose $x \in \mathfrak{c}(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})$ Then $x = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} c_\alpha(a_\alpha + b_\alpha)$ where $a_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}, b_\alpha \in \mathfrak{b}, c_\alpha \in \mathfrak{c}$

$$x = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} c_\alpha(a_\alpha + b_\alpha) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} (c_\alpha a_\alpha + c_\alpha b_\alpha) = \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} c_\alpha a_\alpha + \sum_{\alpha \in \mathcal{A}} c_\alpha b_\alpha \in \mathfrak{c}\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c}\mathfrak{b}.$$

(Note, we could use distributive law and split the sum because we are working with finite summands.)

Therefore, $\mathfrak{c}(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{c}\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c}\mathfrak{b}$.

The other inclusion could be proved similarly. □

However, intersection does not distribute over sum in general. Best we have in this direction is the following:

**Lemma 5.12** (Modular Law for Intersection and Sum)
$\mathfrak{c} \cap (\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) = \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$ for ideals $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}, \mathfrak{c}$ in ring $R$ if $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$ or $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$ or

*Proof.* Given $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$ or $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$ is true. Without loss of generality, suppose $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$ is true.

Let $x \in \mathfrak{c} \cap (\mathfrak{b} + \mathfrak{c})$. Then $x \in \mathfrak{c}$ and $x \in \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}$. Then $x = a + b$ for some $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{b}$. Since $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{c}$, we have $a \in \mathfrak{c}$. So $b = (a + b) - a \in \mathfrak{c}$ as we already had $x = a + b \in \mathfrak{c}$. Ultimately we have, $a \in \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$. Therefore, $a + b \in \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$. So we have proven $\mathfrak{c} \cap (\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$.

To show the other inclusion, let $x \in \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$. Then $x = a + b$ for some $a \in \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$. That means $a, b \in \mathfrak{c}$ and $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{b}$. So $a + b \in \mathfrak{c}$ and $a + b \in \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}$. So $x = a + b \in \mathfrak{c} \cap (\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})$, proving $\mathfrak{c} \cap (\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) \supseteq \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$. □

However, intersection does distribute over sum in $\mathbb{Z}$ unconditionally.

**Exercise 5.13**
Show that $\mathfrak{c} \cap (\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}) = \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{c} \cap \mathfrak{b}$ for ideals $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}, \mathfrak{c}$ in ring $\mathbb{Z}$.

*Proof.* Since all the ideals in $\mathbb{Z}$ are principle, $\mathfrak{a} = (m), \mathfrak{b} = (n), \mathfrak{c} = (k)$ for some $m, n, k \in \mathbb{Z}$

Using Example 5.2 and Example 5.7 we can reduce problem to proving the equality of ideals

$$(\operatorname{lcm}(k, \gcd(m, n))) = (\gcd(\operatorname{lcm}(k, m)), \operatorname{lcm}(k, n)),$$

which further reduce the problem to showing the equality

$$\operatorname{lcm}(k, \gcd(m, n)) = \gcd(\operatorname{lcm}(k, m)), \operatorname{lcm}(k, n) \tag{1}$$

So, for each prime $P$, if exponent of $P$ in the prime factorisation of both sides are equal, then we are done. We now compare exponents of primes on both sides of Equation 1:

Let prime factorisation of $m, n, k$ as follows:

$$m = \prod_{P \text{ prime}} P^\alpha, \quad n = \prod_{P \text{ prime}} P^\beta, \quad k = \prod_{P \text{ prime}} P^\gamma, \quad \text{where } \alpha, \beta, \gamma \text{ are on-negative integers.}$$

For a particular prime $P$, let exponent of $P$ in $m, n, k$ are $\alpha, \beta, \gamma$ respectively. Then exponent of prime $P$ on the left-side is:

$$\max\{\gamma, \gcd(m, n)\} = \max\{\gamma, \min\{\alpha, \beta\}\}.$$

Similarly, exponent of prime $P$ on the right-side is:

$$\min\{\max\{\gamma, \alpha\}, \max\{\gamma, \beta\}\}.$$

We claim that both exponents are are indeed equal:

**Claim 5.14.** $\max\{\gamma, \min\{\alpha, \beta\}\} = \min\{\max\{\gamma, \alpha\}, \max\{\gamma, \beta\}\}$.

*Proof of claim.* Assume without loss of generality that $\alpha \leq \beta$. Then $\min\{\alpha, \beta\} = \alpha$. So left-hand side becomes: $\max\{\gamma, \alpha\}$

For the right-side, since $\alpha \leq \beta, \max\{\gamma, \alpha\} \leq \max\{\gamma, \beta)\}$. Therefore, $\min(\max\{\gamma, \alpha\}, \max\{\gamma, \beta)\} = \max\{\gamma, \alpha\}$. Thus both sides are equal. □

Therefore, $\max\{\gamma, \min\{\alpha, \beta\}\} = \min\{\max\{\gamma, \alpha\}, \max\{\gamma, \beta\}\}$, which completes the proof. □

**Proposition 5.15**
Suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are ideals in $R$. Then $(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{ab}$.

*Proof.* Let $x \in (\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b})$. Then

$$x = \sum_{\alpha \in A} x_\alpha y_\alpha,$$

where $x_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}$ and $y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}$.

Since $y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}$, we have $y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{b}$.

Also, because $x_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b}$, we may write $x_\alpha = x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{a}} + x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{b}}$, where $x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{a}} \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{b}} \in \mathfrak{b}$. Thus,

$$x = \sum_{\alpha \in A} (x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{a}} + x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{b}}) y_\alpha = \sum_{\alpha \in A} x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{a}} y_\alpha + \sum_{\alpha \in A} x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{b}} y_\alpha.$$

Since $x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{a}} \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{b}$, we have $x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{a}} y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{ab}$. Similarly, $x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{b}} \in \mathfrak{b}$ and $y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}$, so $x_\alpha^{\mathfrak{b}} y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{ab}$.

Hence each term lies in $\mathfrak{ab}$, and therefore $x \in \mathfrak{ab}$. □

Again, for in $\mathbb{Z}$, the above statement holds true in both direction, which can be proven easily using similar arguments as Exercise 5.13.

Moving on, notice, if $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$ are coprime, then using Example 5.2, we can conclude that $(m) + (n) = (1) = \mathbb{Z}$. We generalise this statement for any ring $R$, and give the following definition:

**Definition 5.16** (Coprimality of Two Ideals)
Two ideals $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$ in $R$ are said to be *coprime* to each other if $\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b} = (1)$

If $\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}$ are coprime, then it will happen that there exists $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $b \in \mathfrak{b}$ such that $a + b = 1$.

**Definition 5.17** (Direct Product of Rings)
Suppose $A_1, A_2, \ldots, A_n$ are all commutative rings with multiplicative identities. Then their *direct product*

$$A = \prod_{i=1}^{n} A_i$$

is the set of all sequences $x = (x_1, \ldots, x_n)$ with $x_i \in A_i$. $A$ is a commutative unital ring with pointwise addition and multiplication.

We have projections $\pi_k i : A \Longrightarrow A_i$ defined by $\pi_i(x) = x_i$; they are ring homomorphisms.

**Proposition 5.18**
Let $R$ be a ring and $\mathfrak{a}_1, \mathfrak{a}_2, \ldots, \mathfrak{a}_n$ ideals of $R$. Define homomorphism

$$\Phi : R \longrightarrow \prod_{i=1}^{n} (R/\mathfrak{a}_i)$$

by the rule $\Phi(x) = (x + \mathfrak{a}_1, \ldots, x + \mathfrak{a}_n)$. Then

i If $\mathfrak{a}_i, \mathfrak{a}_j$ are coprime whenever $i \neq j$, then the product $\mathfrak{a}_1 \cdots \mathfrak{a}_n = \bigcap_{i=1}^{n} \mathfrak{a}_i$.

ii $\Phi$ is surjective if and only if $\mathfrak{a}_i$ and $\mathfrak{a}_j$ are coprime whenever $i \neq j$.

iii $\Phi$ is injective if and only if $\bigcap_{i=1}^{n} \mathfrak{a}_i = (0)$.

*Proof of (i).* We use induction on $n$.

**Base case:** $n = 2$. Suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are coprime, i.e. $\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b} = R$. Then there exist $x \in \mathfrak{a}$ and $y \in \mathfrak{b}$ such that $x + y = 1$.

First, $\mathfrak{ab} \subseteq \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}$, since if

$$z = \sum_{\alpha} x_\alpha y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{ab} \quad (x_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a},\ y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{b}),$$

then each $x_\alpha y_\alpha \in \mathfrak{a}$ and in $\mathfrak{b}$, hence $z \in \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}$.

Conversely, $(\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b})(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{ab}$, in general using Proposition 5.15. And since $\mathfrak{a} + \mathfrak{b} = (1) = R$, we obtain $R(\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b}) \subseteq \mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} \subseteq \mathfrak{ab}$. Thus,

$$\mathfrak{a} \cap \mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{ab}.$$

**Induction step.** Assume the state be true for some $k \geq 2$. We want to show that the statement is also true for $n = k + 1$.

Suppose $\mathfrak{a}_1, \ldots, \mathfrak{a}_{k+1}$ are pairwise coprime.

By the induction hypothesis,

$$\mathfrak{a}_1 \cdots \mathfrak{a}_k = \bigcap_{i=1}^{k} \mathfrak{a}_i.$$

It suffices to show that

$$\left( \bigcap_{i=1}^{k} \mathfrak{a}_i \right) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathfrak{a}_{k+1}$$

are coprime.

Since each $\mathfrak{a}_i$ is coprime with $\mathfrak{a}_{k+1}$, for each $i = 1, \ldots, k$ there exist $x_i \in \mathfrak{a}_i, y_i \in \mathfrak{a}_{k+1}$ such that $x_i + y_i = 1$.

Consider

$$x := x_1 x_2 \cdots x_k \in \prod_{i=1}^{k} \mathfrak{a}_i.$$

Since $x_i = 1 - y_i$, we have

$$x = \prod_{i=1}^{k} (1 - y_i) = 1 + y,$$

where $y = -(y_1 + \cdots + y_k) + \sum_{1 \leq i < j \leq k} y_i y_j + \cdots (-1)^k y_1 \cdots y_k \in \mathfrak{a}_{k+1}$ (because the expansion consists of sums of products of the $y_i$'s).

Thus,

$$x + (-y) = 1,$$

with $x \in \bigcap_{i=1}^{k} \mathfrak{a}_i, (-y) \in \mathfrak{a}_{k+1}$.

Hence,

$$\left(\bigcap_{i=1}^{k} \mathfrak{a}_i\right) + \mathfrak{a}_{k+1} = (1),$$

so they are coprime.

Applying the case $n = 2$, we obtain

$$\bigcap_{i=1}^{k+1} \mathfrak{a}_i = \left(\bigcap_{i=1}^{k} \mathfrak{a}_i\right) \cap \mathfrak{a}_{k+1} = (\mathfrak{a}_1 \cdots \mathfrak{a}_k)\mathfrak{a}_{k+1} = \mathfrak{a}_1 \cdots \mathfrak{a}_k \mathfrak{a}_{k+1}.$$

By induction, the proof is complete. □

*To be continued...*

# References

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